

## You are Emoji!

Apple iOS 5 devices have Emoji onboard, a comprehensive emoticons keyboard with over 700 symbols <http://bit.ly/uwQJBQ>

## Google Currents reads well

Google has launched its long rumoured magazine reading application called "Google Currents", for Android and iOS <http://bit.ly/sHoe5m>

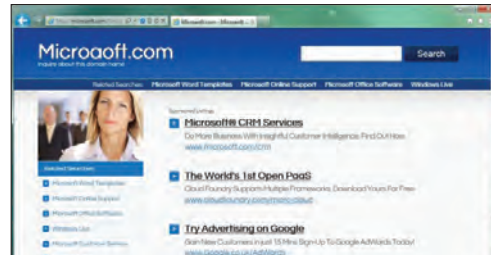
# Typosquatting threats and more

The latest threats doing the rounds – they hit closer to home than you may think

## Beware of Typosquatting sites

Internet security firm, Sophos cautions users to be careful while typing URLs, following the results of its study into the scale of "typosquatting". Typosquatters register misspellings of popular web sites in the hope of making money out of traffic from unintentional typing mistakes by internet surfers. The study looked for registered web sites for every single one letter typo of the URL: one letter omitted (eg Aple), one letter mistyped (eg Tritter) or one letter added (Ffacebook).

The study revealed that there's a significant typosquatting ecosystem around high-profile, often-typed domain names. A



### Mistyped URL

the intention of being held onto and sold at a profit, which is also known as "domain parking".

Of the 14,495 misspelled URLs looked at in the study, 738 (5.1 per cent) were categorised by Sophos as cybercrime or adult. The former should always be blocked; the latter should be blocked at least in the workplace or around children.



Losing your pen drive here would be a big mistake

huge 86 per cent of the possible one letter misspellings of the Apple homepage led to typosquatting sites.

The highest proportion of the squatting sites – 15 per cent – led to advertising sites. Cybercriminals will register misspelled sites to make advertising revenue every time someone mistypes the name of a popular site. Twelve per cent were found to be IT and hosting pages – suggesting that they've been registered with

## Encrypt your pen drive

Another recent study by Sophos warns users to be careful with their USB memory sticks. Sophos' Australian office conducted the experiment by purchasing a job-lot of found USB sticks from

a lost property auction run by major transit authority, RailCorp in Sydney.

The study revealed that two-thirds of the

50 tested USB sticks were infected with malware, and contained information about many of the former owners of the devices, their families, friends and colleagues.

Files contained on the unprotected devices included tax documents, school and university assignments, AutoCAD drawings of work projects, photo albums of family and friends and software and web source code. Disturbingly, none of the owners had used any sort of encryption to secure their files against unauthorised snoopers.

"It seems that commuters down under are not only losing their USB sticks, and oblivious to the fact that they were carrying malware around in their pockets, but are also at risk of losing their identity and personal information through sloppy security," said Graham Cluley, Senior Technology Consultant at Sophos. "Although this study was done in Sydney, Australia, there's no reason to believe that we wouldn't see a similar story on Delhi or Bangalore Metro and Mumbai's suburban local trains. Folks need to wake up to the threats, and take appropriate preventative steps."

Sophos advises computer users to encrypt all personal and business data before storing it on USB keys so that it can't be accessed if devices are lost. In addition, by running up-to-date

anti-virus, even if you have a Mac – some of the USB sticks in the study were lost by Mac users, yet still contained PC malware – you can prevent spreading malware and protect yourself when using shared USB drives.

## Bot prevention gets better

Check Point Software Technologies has launched its latest security tool, the Anti-Bot Software Blade.

A bot is a malicious software that enables cybercriminals to take over computers and execute illegal activities – such as stealing data, gaining access to unauthorised network resources, initiating Denial of Service (DoS) attacks or distributing spam. Bots are remotely controlled, typically disguised and operate without the users' knowledge. Bots are also often used as tools in targeted attacks known as Advanced Persistent Threats (APT), such as Stuxnet and Operation Aurora.

Check Point's new Anti-Bot Software Blade is designed to discover bots and prevent damages by blocking communication between infected hosts and remote operators. The new solution will be integrated into every gateway to provide businesses with multi-layered bot prevention against malware threats, with high traffic performance of over 40 Gbps – ensuring all channels of business communication remain secure.

The solution features Check Point's Multi-tier ThreatSpect, a unique detection engine that analyses traffic on every gateway, identifies millions of outbreak types and discovers bots by correlating multiple risk factors. **[d]**